Shocking!

14 At this point I applied a generous coat of cellulose sanding sealer and, to my horror, found that the cellulose dissolved the red colour from the padauk and stained all of the plywood a rather delicate shade of pink. With no other remedy available, I bit the bullet and re-sanded the whole thing again and then sealed it much more carefully, taking care not to transfer colour from the padauk to the plywood

The bottom

15 Using a 3mm parting tool, part off the hollow form from the waste in the chuck. Work carefully as you approach the centre and stop before parting all the way through. Make sure the bottom of the form is slightly concave so that it will sit on the outer edge without rocking. Stop the lathe and cut through the small stub with a hacksaw blade to complete the parting off. Remove the stub and sand the bottom on a 50mm power sanding disc held in the chuck. Hold the workpiece at an angle to the disc so you can sand all the way into the centre while retaining a crisp outer edge on the foot

16 The chuck jaws do not close enough to grip the sanding disc and so hold it in the chuck in a small disc of scrap wood. Drill a 6mm hole and make a saw cut into it. This allows the wood to flex slightly and grip the spindle when the chuck jaws are tightened

17 Finish with a final polish using a buffing system to give it a good shine

18 I used the same technique to make two smaller versions with dimensions two thirds and one third of the original. The sashes are made from roupala (*Roupala brasiliensis*) and ebony (*Diospyros spp.*) respectively. All three are now in a private collection ●

HANDY HINTS

1. When working with laminated pieces take precautions against glue failure. Full face protection is recommended. This is especially true when working with plywood, which is well-known to contain voids and where the quality of the manufacturer's glue is unknown
2. When working with a combination of pale and highly coloured woods, test if your sanding sealer will dissolve colour
3. After sanding I now use a quick blast of compressed air to blow any highly coloured dust out of the grain of an adjacent pale timber. This is not generally recommended by HSE because it makes more dust airborne and hence more likely to be inhaled. Use with care and wear a good quality dust mask

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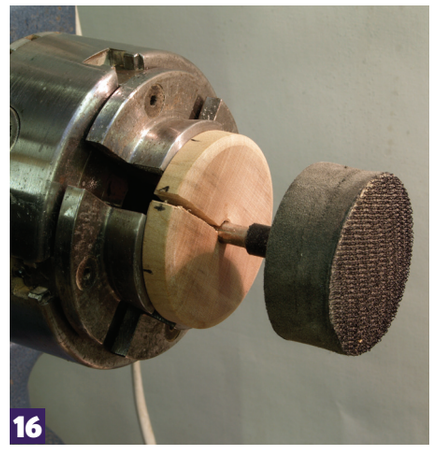
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